Remote Debugging Row-Driven Flink PTF UDFs

Flink TaskManagers are JVM processes, so you can enable **Java remote debugging (JDWP)** and attach your IDE (VS Code or IntelliJ IDEA) to them.

This guide covers both row-driven PTFs in this package: `UserEventEnricher` (set semantics, stateful) and `OrderLineExpander` (row semantics, stateless). Because both UDFs ship in the same uber JAR, run inside the same TaskManager pod, and live in the same Gradle subproject (`app`), they share **one** debug configuration: **"Attach to Flink TaskManager (Row-Driven)"**. The only thing that differs between debugging the two is *where* you set the breakpoint and *which* `make produce-...-record` target you run to trigger it.

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> JDWP is already enabled on the TaskManager, debug configurations for both VS Code and IntelliJ IDEA are in place, and port-forwarding is automated as a pre-launch task. Once your cluster is running and the UDFs are deployed, use the **"Attach to Flink TaskManager (Row-Driven)"** debug configuration to attach to the remote JVM and hit your breakpoints in *either* `UserEventEnricher.java` or `OrderLineExpander.java`.
>
> **Note:** Make sure you select the **"Attach to Flink TaskManager (Row-Driven)"** configuration before launching the debugger. Starting a *launch* (rather than *attach*) configuration will attempt to run a local Java process, which fails because UDFs have no `main()` method.
>
> - **VS Code:** Open the **Run and Debug** panel (⇧⌘D), select **"Attach to Flink TaskManager (Row-Driven)"** from the dropdown, then press **F5**.
> - **IntelliJ IDEA:** Open the **Run/Debug Configurations** dropdown (top-right toolbar), select **"Attach to Flink TaskManager (Row-Driven)"**, then click **Debug** (^D / Shift+F9).

1.0 Quick Start

1.1 Common setup (do this once)

These steps are identical for both UDFs — `make deploy-cp-ptf-udf-row-driven` builds the uber JAR and registers **both** functions (`user_event_enricher` and `order_line_expander`) in the same Flink SQL session, then starts both `INSERT INTO ...` pipelines.

1. **Deploy** the full stack and the UDFs:

```
make cp-up                          # Confluent Platform + Kafka UI
make flink-up                       # Flink Operator + CMF + Flink
session cluster
make deploy-cp-ptf-udf-row-driven   # Build UDF JAR, copy to Flink
pods, submit SQL
```

2. Select the **"Attach to Flink TaskManager (Row-Driven)"** debug configuration in your IDE:
   - **VS Code:** Open **Run and Debug** (⇧⌘D) and choose it from the dropdown
   - **IntelliJ IDEA:** Choose it from the **Run/Debug Configurations** dropdown (top-right toolbar)
3. **Start the debugger** — your IDE will port-forward to the TaskManager pod automatically, then attach:
   - **VS Code:** Press **F5**
   - **IntelliJ IDEA:** Click **Debug** (^D / Shift+F9)
4. Now follow §1.2 *or* §1.3 below depending on which UDF you want to debug. You can switch between the two without restarting the debugger — just set a breakpoint in the other file and produce a record to its source topic.

1.2 Debugging `UserEventEnricher` (set semantics, stateful)

1. **Set a breakpoint** — open `UserEventEnricher.java` and click in the gutter at the first line of the `eval()` method:

```
String eventType = input.getFieldAs("event_type");
```

2. **Send a test event** to trigger the breakpoint:

```
make produce-user-events-record
```

3. **Debug** — your IDE pauses at your breakpoint. Inspect `input`, `state`, and local variables, step through the session logic, and watch `state.sessionId` and `state.eventCount` update as you step over lines. Because this is a *set-semantic* PTF, the `state` parameter is preloaded with the per-`user_id` POJO Flink restored from the keyed state backend — produce a few events for the same `user_id` and you'll see the counters accumulate across breakpoint hits.

1.3 Debugging `OrderLineExpander` (row semantics, stateless)

1. **Set a breakpoint** — open `OrderLineExpander.java` and click in the gutter at the first line of the `eval()` method:

   ```
   String orderId  = input.getFieldAs("order_id");
   ```

   Or, to inspect the per-item emission, set a breakpoint inside the expansion `for` loop on the `collect(Row.of(...))` call.

2. **Send a test order** to trigger the breakpoint:

   ```
   make produce-orders-record
   ```

   The sample record has three items in its comma-separated list, so `eval()` fires once and the `for` loop inside it emits three rows.

3. **Debug** — your IDE pauses at your breakpoint. Inspect `input`, the parsed `itemParts` and `quantityParts` arrays, and step through the `for` loop watching `i`, `itemName`, `qty`, and the `collect()` call. Notice the differences from `UserEventEnricher`:

   - There is **no `state` parameter** — row semantics forbids `@StateHint`, so nothing is preserved between rows. Inspecting between two consecutive `eval()` invocations confirms the function carries no memory of the previous order.
   - There is **no `Context` parameter** — no timers or keyed-state services are accessible.
   - A single `eval()` call emits **multiple output rows** via repeated `collect()` calls — the canonical one-to-many pattern that distinguishes row-semantic PTFs from scalar UDFs.

2.0 How It Works

2.1 JDWP on the Flink TaskManager

> JDWP (Java Debug Wire Protocol) is the protocol used for communication between a debugger (like VS Code or IntelliJ) and a Java Virtual Machine (JVM) being debugged. It's part of the Java Platform Debugger Architecture (JPDA).
>
> Key points:
>
> - **Purpose:** Defines the format of requests and replies between the debugger front-end and the JVM.
> - **Transport:** Typically runs over a socket connection (TCP/IP), which is what enables **remote debugging** — the debugger and JVM can be on different machines.
> - **How it's enabled:** You pass JVM arguments like:
>
> `-agentlib:jdwp=transport=dt_socket,server=y,suspend=n,address=*:5005`
>
> - `transport=dt_socket` — use TCP sockets
> - `server=y` — the JVM listens for a debugger to attach

> - `suspend=n` — don't pause the JVM on startup waiting for a debugger (`y` would pause)
> - `address=*:5005` — listen on port `5005`

The FlinkDeployment CR (`k8s/base/flink-basic-deployment.yaml`) includes the JDWP agent flag in the Flink configuration:

```
flinkConfiguration:
  env.java.opts.taskmanager: "-agentlib:jdwp=transport=dt_socket,server=y,suspend=n,address=*:5005"
  heartbeat.timeout: "300000"
```

- `suspend=n` — the JVM starts normally (use `suspend=y` if you need it to wait for the debugger before processing)
- `address=*:5005` — listens on port `5005`
- `heartbeat.timeout` — increased to `5 minutes` so pausing at breakpoints doesn't kill the TaskManager

2.2 Supplemental RBAC

Flink's Kubernetes session-cluster executor needs to GET the JobManager REST service (e.g. `flink-basic-rest`) to submit jobs. The Helm-managed Role for the `flink` ServiceAccount grants access to pods, configmaps, and deployments — but **not services**.

The manifest `k8s/base/flink-rbac.yaml` fills this gap with a supplemental Role and RoleBinding:

```
rules:
  - apiGroups: [""]
    resources: ["services"]
    verbs: ["get", "list", "watch"]
```

This is additive — Kubernetes merges permissions across all Roles bound to the same subject, so the Helm-managed Role is unaffected. The `flink-rbac` Makefile target applies this manifest and runs automatically as a dependency of `flink-deploy`.

2.3 Port Forwarding (automated)

Both IDEs run a helper script (`scripts/port-forward-taskmanager.sh`) as a pre-launch / "Before launch" step that:

1. Kills any existing port-forward on port `5005`
2. Discovers the TaskManager pod by label (`component=taskmanager`)
3. Starts `kubectl port-forward` in the background (detached via `nohup`/`disown` so it survives after the task shell exits)
4. Waits for port `5005` to be listening
5. Exits with success — the IDE then proceeds to attach the debugger

VS Code triggers the script via a task in `.vscode/tasks.json`:

```
{
    "label": "Port Forward Flink TaskManager",
    "type": "shell",
    "command": "${workspaceFolder}/scripts/port-forward-taskmanager.sh"
}
```

IntelliJ IDEA triggers the same script via a Shell Script run configuration (`.idea/runConfigurations/Port_Forward_Flink_TaskManager.xml`) that is wired as a "Before launch" step in the debug configuration.

If you need to port-forward manually (e.g., outside your IDE):

```
kubectl port-forward -n confluent <taskmanager-pod> 5005:5005
```

2.4 IDE Debug Configurations

Both IDEs ship a pre-configured **"Attach to Flink TaskManager (Row-Driven)"** remote debug configuration. The attach configuration wires the port-forward script as a pre-launch step so the entire flow is one click.

2.4.1 VS Code (`.vscode/launch.json`)

```
{
  "type": "java",
  "name": "Attach to Flink TaskManager (Row-Driven)",
  "request": "attach",
  "hostName": "localhost",
  "port": 5005,
  "projectName": "app",
  "preLaunchTask": "Port Forward Flink TaskManager"
}
```

The `projectName` is `"app"` because that is the Gradle subproject name defined in `examples/ptf_udf_row_driven/java/settings.gradle.kts`. This tells the debugger which classpath and source roots to use for resolving breakpoints. Both `UserEventEnricher` and `OrderLineExpander` live under the same `app` subproject, so this single configuration resolves breakpoints in either file with no additional setup.

2.4.2 IntelliJ IDEA (`.idea/runConfigurations/`)

IntelliJ run configurations are stored as XML and are automatically recognized when you open the project:

Run Configuration	What it does

Run Configuration	What it does
Port Forward Flink TaskManager	Shell Script config that runs `scripts/port-forward-taskmanager.sh` to `kubectl port-forward` port `5005` to the TaskManager pod
Attach to Flink TaskManager (Row-Driven)	Remote JVM Debug config that attaches to `localhost:5005`. The port-forward config runs automatically as a "Before launch" task

> **Note:** The Shell Script run configuration requires the **Shell Script** plugin, which is bundled with IntelliJ IDEA 2020.2+.

3.0 Important Caveats

- **TaskManager must be running** — the TaskManager pod only exists while a Flink job is active. Deploy the UDFs first (`make deploy-cp-ptf-udf-row-driven`) before attaching the debugger
- **Source must match** — the local code you have open in your IDE must match the JAR deployed to the cluster, or breakpoints won't align
- **Timeouts** — pausing too long at a breakpoint can trigger Flink's heartbeat timeout, causing the TaskManager to be considered dead. The `heartbeat.timeout` is already set to `5 minutes` in the Flink config
- **Single TaskManager** — if you have multiple TaskManagers, you're only attached to one. Debug with `parallelism=1` to keep things simple
- **`suspend=y`** is useful if you need to debug the `open()` lifecycle method, since it pauses the JVM before any processing starts
- **Row-semantic distribution** — `OrderLineExpander` is a row-semantic PTF, so the framework is free to distribute rows across virtual processors in any order. If you produce multiple orders in quick succession your breakpoint may fire on any TaskManager slot, and rows from different orders may interleave at the breakpoint in arbitrary order. Use the `order_id` (or another input field) in the watch panel to disambiguate which row you're inspecting. `UserEventEnricher` is unaffected by this — its set semantics guarantees that all rows for the same `user_id` are routed to the same processor

4.0 For Confluent Cloud

*Remote debugging is **NOT POSSIBLE** on Confluent Cloud — you don't have access to the underlying JVMs. For that environment, stick with local MiniCluster integration tests or logging.*